



THE HISTORY PORTAL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDITION 2026.1

HOW DID DECADES OF IMPERIAL RIVALRY AND FEAR CULMINATE IN THIRTY DAYS OF MADNESS?

KS3: Causes of the Great War

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Level	Emerging (1-2)	Emerging+ (3)	Expected (4-5)	Expected+ (6-7) / Greater Depth (8-9)
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments	
L1: How was the German Empire created in 1871?				
L2: How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?				
L3: To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?				
L4: Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations?				
L5: Did the Alliance System protect Europe or guarantee a global war?				
L6: Why did a single assassination in Sarajevo ignite a World War?				
Final Unit Grade:				

L1: How was the German Empire created in 1871?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand how Prussia used economic dominance (the Zollverein) and military reform to eclipse Austria.
- ☐ Analyze how Bismarck orchestrated three short, decisive wars to achieve unification.
- ☐ Evaluate the geopolitical consequences of the proclamation at Versailles and the annexation of Alsace-Lorraine.

Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: Circle ONE term that does not belong with the others. Explain your reasoning: What historical connection links the other terms, and why is your chosen term different?

Realpolitik | Blood and Iron | Zollverein | Alsace-Lorraine | Balance of Power

Q1. Explain how Otto von Bismarck used "blood and iron" and diplomatic calculation to forge the German Empire in 1871.

[illegible]

Level: [1 / 2 / 3 / 4]

Marks: / 16

Teacher Target:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.



L2: How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how the Hohenzollern crisis and the Ems Telegram provoked France into war in 1870.
- ☐ Analyze the military catastrophe of Sedan and the brutal Siege of Paris.
- ☐ Evaluate how "la revanche" and Bettannier's "La Tache Noire" institutionalized anti-German sentiment in France.

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: Choose TWO terms from the word bank. Write ONE grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (because, although, or consequently):

La Revanche | Ems Telegram | Treaty of Frankfurt | Sedan | Siege of Paris

Q1. Explain how the Franco-Prussian War and the annexation of Alsace-Lorraine created a lasting legacy of hatred between France and Germany.

[illegible]

Level: [1 / 2 / 3 / 4]

Marks: / 16

Teacher Target:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.



L3: To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

☐ Contrast Bismarck’s continental diplomacy with Kaiser Wilhelm II’s "Weltpolitik".
☐ Analyze how the First Moroccan Crisis (1905) consolidated the Anglo-French Entente Cordiale.
☐ Evaluate the impact of the Agadir Crisis (1911) and the dispatch of the SMS Panther.

Vocabulary Check

Conceptual Classification: Categorise the terms from the word bank into the two historical boxes below:

Weltpolitik | Platz an der Sonne | Entente Cordiale | Gunboat Diplomacy | Einkreisung

Power, Governance & Warfare

Economy, Trade & Society

Q1. Explain how Kaiser Wilhelm II's policy of Weltpolitik and the Moroccan Crises drove Britain and France into a united diplomatic alliance against Germany.

[illegible]

Level: [1 / 2 / 3 / 4]

Marks: / 16

Teacher Target:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.



L4: Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

☐ Explain the principles of the British Two-Power Standard and Tirpitz's "Risk Theory".
☐ Analyze the revolutionary technology of HMS Dreadnought and Admiral Jackie Fisher's reforms.
☐ Evaluate how public hysteria and popular slogans ("We want eight and we won't wait!") drove the naval arms race.

Vocabulary Check

Spot the Deliberate Error: Read the statement below. One historical fact or vocabulary concept has been deliberately falsified. Underline the error and explain the accurate historical reality below:

Two-Power Standard | Dreadnought | Risk Theory | Kiel Canal | Splendid Isolation

Challenge: Write ONE statement containing a deliberate historical misconception using **Two-Power Standard** or **Dreadnought**. Swap with a partner to identify and correct the error:

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Teacher Target:

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

L5: Did the Alliance System protect Europe or guarantee a global war?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

☐ Explain the formation of the Dual Alliance (1879) and Triple Alliance (1882).

☐ Analyze why the lapse of the Reinsurance Treaty led to the Franco-Russian Alliance (1894).

☐ Evaluate the mechanics of the Schlieffen Plan and the rigidity of military mobilization.

Vocabulary Check

***The Odd One Out:** Circle ONE term that does not belong with the others. Explain your reasoning: What historical connection links the other terms, and why is your chosen term different?*

Triple Alliance | Triple Entente | Schlieffen Plan | Reinsurance Treaty | Mobilization

[illegible]

Teacher Target:

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.



L6: Why did a single assassination in Sarajevo ignite a World War?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain why Archduke Franz Ferdinand was targeted by the Black Hand in Sarajevo on 28 June 1914.
- ☐ Analyze the fateful coincidences and wrong turns during the assassination on 28 June 1914.
- ☐ Evaluate the July Crisis, the German "Blank Cheque", and the domino effect of European mobilization.

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: Choose *TWO* terms from the word bank. Write *ONE* grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (because, although, or consequently):

Blank Cheque | Black Hand | Ultimatum | Pan-Slavism | July Crisis

Q1. Explain why the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand in Sarajevo led directly to the outbreak of the First World War in August 1914.

[illegible]

Level: [1 / 2 / 3 / 4]

Marks: / 16

Teacher Target:

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.

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End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Causes of the Great War (1870–1914)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)